PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

CareLink: a digital booking and management platform for an existing babysitting and nanny agency

CareLink digitises the caregiver discovery, booking and review lifecycle for one real, currently operating caregiving agency in Ghana — giving parents a way to find and book verified staff online, giving staff a profile and a schedule they control, and giving the agency the first structured record of its own operations.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

DOCUMENT	Product Requirements Document (PRD)
PRODUCT	CareLink — booking and staff-management platform
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STATUS	Baseline for development — approved scope for the August–September 2026 build window
RELATED DOCUMENTS	Technical Design (2), App Flow (3), Design Brief (4), Backend Schema (5), Engineering Plan (6)

1. Overview and vision

CareLink sits at the intersection of caregiving technology and small-business digitisation. The product is being built in partnership with a real caregiving agency operating in Ghana that places babysitters and nannies with families. The agency trades today entirely by phone and in person: bookings are arranged in conversation, staff records live in notebooks and heads, and payment is collected in cash. Nothing about its operations is recorded in a form the agency can search, audit or report on.

This is deliberately not a hypothetical marketplace. CareLink is the agency's actual system of record. Every design decision favours the agency's real workflow over the generic two-sided-marketplace pattern: the administrator can place staff on the roster directly, because that is how the agency already recruits; verification runs in both directions, because the agency vouches for staff to families and needs assurance about the families it sends staff into; and the staff experience assumes variable literacy, because a meaningful share of the workforce would abandon a self-service sign-up designed for the general public.

Vision statement

Any parent in the agency's service area should be able to find, judge and book a verified caregiver in under five minutes, without a phone call — and every booking made should leave behind a record the agency can stand behind.

Product principles

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Trust is the feature	Verification state, ratings and locked booking terms are never buried. If a user cannot tell why they should trust a counterparty, the screen has failed.
Say it once	A parent describes a child's routine, medication and needs one time, in a Ward Care Profile. Every subsequent booking carries it automatically.
Explain the ranking	Search results are ranked by a weighted score whose breakdown is visible. No opaque relevance.
Literacy is not a prerequisite	Every task a staff member must complete is achievable with voice input, read-aloud and iconography.
AI assists, never decides	The language model parses search phrasing and offers a photo plausibility opinion. A human administrator makes every verification decision.

2. Problem statement

The agency's manual operation produces six concrete, observable failures.
Each one is the origin of a feature area later in this document.

PROBLEM	CONSEQUENCE TODAY	ADDRESSED BY
No digital presence	The agency cannot be discovered or booked online; every booking depends on the customer already holding a phone number.	Public staff directory, search, booking request flow
No verified staff records	Identity documents, references and certifications are held informally or not at all, with no reviewable trail.	Bidirectional verification workflow, document store, admin review queue
No centralised booking record	Times, rates and terms are agreed verbally, leaving disputes with nothing to arbitrate against.	Booking entity with locked-in terms and an auditable status history
Repeated manual briefing	Parents re-explain routines, medication and needs to every newly assigned staff member.	Persistent Ward Care Profile per child
Cash payment friction	No digital payment record; cash-handling risk carried by staff.	Mobile Money payment flow attached to the booking
No reputation system	Past performance is invisible to a parent at the moment of decision.	Post-booking rating and review, public average on the profile

3. Goals and success metrics

3.1 Product goals

1. Give the agency a working online booking presence with minimal disruption to how it already operates.

2. Establish a structured, role-based record of staff, parents, bookings, payments and verification evidence.
3. Reduce the effort of arranging a booking for both sides, and remove repeated briefing entirely.
4. Raise measured trust in a booking made through the platform versus the current phone arrangement.
5. Keep the staff-side experience usable by a caregiver who reads with difficulty.

3.2 Success metrics

METRIC	TARGET	METHOD
Booking completion time	50% faster than the informal phone process	Timed trials, same scenario, both routes
User satisfaction	Mean above 4 of 5	Post-test questionnaire, 10–15 participants
Transaction error rate	Under 2% of transactions	Automated error logging
Perceived trust improvement	Majority report increased trust	Post-test questionnaire
Natural-language search accuracy	Correct filter extraction on a majority of a labelled query set	Manual review against a pre-labelled sample
Ward Care Profile effectiveness	Majority of staff report their questions were answered upfront	Post-test staff questionnaire
Photo plausibility check usefulness	Administrator finds the result a helpful second opinion in a majority of reviews	Administrator questionnaire, against manual-only baseline
Matching relevance	Ranked results rated more relevant than an unranked filtered list	Side-by-side comparison task

4. Users and roles

Three actors, matching how the agency actually operates. Role-based access control governs every screen and every data read.

ACTOR	RESPONSIBILITIES AND PERMITTED ACTIONS
Parent / guardian	Registers and builds a household profile with an emergency contact; creates a Ward Care Profile per child; submits ID, a reference and optionally a live photo for verification; searches and filters staff or describes a need in plain language; views ranked matches with a score breakdown; sends a booking request; messages the assigned staff member; pays via Mobile Money; sees the staff member's emergency contact only while a session is active; leaves a rating and review; reports an issue.
Staff (caregiver: babysitter / nanny)	Builds a profile with bio, hourly rate, experience, availability, skill tags, optional certifications and an emergency contact; submits their own ID, reference and optional live photo, with voice input and read-aloud available throughout; views incoming requests including the parent's verification badge and Ward Care Profile; accepts or declines; messages the parent; starts and ends a session; sees the parent's emergency contact only while a session is active; views their own rating and reviews; reports an issue.
Administrator (agency staff)	Adds staff records to the roster; reviews every verification submission from both roles — ID, reference, live photo and the AI plausibility note — and approves or rejects; views and resolves reports; monitors platform-wide statistics including bookings, completion rate and revenue through the platform.

4.1 Primary personas

PERSONA	CONTEXT	NEEDS FROM CARELINK
Ama Parent, 34, Accra	Works full time, needs after-school cover three afternoons a week. Has used the agency twice by phone and was uneasy both times about who arrived at her door.	To see who she is getting before they arrive; to stop re-explaining her daughter's asthma inhaler; to pay by Mobile Money and have a record of it.
Akosua Staff, 27, six years' experience	Reads short text slowly and prefers to be told things aloud. Currently learns about work through a phone call the night before, with no notice of what the job involves.	To be found for the work she is actually good at; to know the child's routine before arriving; to be paid without carrying cash.
Mr Owusu Agency manager / administrator	Runs the agency's placements from a phone and a notebook. Has no record of who is verified, which bookings are outstanding, or how much came in last month.	To onboard staff and see their verification state at a glance; to resolve complaints from a record rather than from memory; to see the month's activity and revenue.

5. Scope

5.1 In scope

- Responsive web application for desktop and mobile browsers.
- Role-based access control across Parent, Staff and Administrator.
- Roster function: the administrator creates staff records directly; each staff member then completes their own verification through their own login.
- Bidirectional identity verification for both parents and staff, with document upload and administrator approval or rejection.
- Live photo verification: uploaded ID photo compared against an in-browser selfie capture, with an AI-generated plausibility result shown to the administrator beside both images.

- Staff profiles with experience, rate, availability, skill tags and optional certification uploads.
- Weighted, transparent matching algorithm with a visible score breakdown.
- Structured booking request, accept/decline and status tracking, with terms locked on acceptance.
- Persistent Ward Care Profile per child, editable by the parent, shown automatically to staff on every booking.
- Mobile Money payment flow (MTN, Telecel, AirtelTigo), simulated for this project.
- AI-assisted natural-language search converting plain language into structured filters.
- Voice input and read-aloud support to reduce reliance on reading and writing.
- In-app messaging scoped to a booking; review and rating after completion; issue reporting routed to the administrator.
- Administrator dashboard: roster, verification queue, report queue, platform statistics.

5.2 Out of scope

- Onboarding other, unrelated agencies — this is one agency's system, not a multi-agency marketplace.
- Nurse and home-healthcare bookings (identified future scope).
- Native mobile applications; responsive web only.
- Certified biometric KYC or production-grade facial recognition. The live photo check is an AI plausibility aid to a human reviewer; a production system would integrate a dedicated provider such as Smile ID.
- Live integration with a police or criminal-record database, or a third-party background-check API.
- Real payment settlement with a live Mobile Money aggregator; the flow is simulated.
- Real-time GPS tracking of staff during a booking.
- Multi-language interface support.

6. Functional requirements

Requirements are grouped into twelve feature areas. Priority follows MoSCoW: **M** must have for the build window, **S** should have, **C** could have if time allows. Acceptance criteria here are product-level; the Engineering Plan (document 6) restates them as testable task-level criteria.

F1 · Accounts, roles and access control M

Users register as a parent or sign in to a staff account created for them by the administrator. Every account carries exactly one role, and the role determines which routes, screens and records are reachable.

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Parent self-registration with email and password	A new parent can register, receives a session, and lands on the parent dashboard with verification status *unverified*.
Administrator-created staff accounts	A staff record created from the roster produces a login the staff member can use; on first sign-in they are routed to profile completion.
Role-scoped routing	A signed-in user requesting a route belonging to another role is redirected to their own dashboard; a direct data request for another role's record is refused.
Session persistence and sign-out	A session survives a page reload and is invalidated on sign-out; protected routes are unreachable afterwards.

F2 · Staff profile and availability M

A staff profile is the unit parents search, compare and book. It carries bio, years of experience, hourly rate, service area, weekly availability, skill tags, optional certification uploads and an emergency contact.

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Profile creation and edit	All fields persist and reload correctly; a profile missing a required field is flagged as incomplete and excluded from search.
Skill tags from a fixed vocabulary	Tags are selectable from: infant care, toddler care, school-age supervision, newborn care, meal preparation, special-needs care, light housekeeping, and local languages spoken. Free text is not accepted as a tag.
Weekly availability	Availability is expressed as day-of-week plus time window; a parent cannot request a slot outside declared availability without an explicit override warning.
Certification upload	A staff member can attach a First Aid/CPR or Early Childhood Education certificate; it appears on the profile marked *submitted* until an administrator confirms it.
Accessibility of profile entry	Every free-text field accepts voice input, and every label and helper text can be read aloud.

F3 · Bidirectional identity verification M

Both parents and staff verify themselves. This is the deliberate departure from established caregiver marketplaces, which verify only the caregiver and leave the hiring household unchecked.

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Submission of identity evidence	A user can submit ID type and number (Ghana Card, with passport or voter ID as fallback), an ID photo, and at least one contactable reference. Status moves *unverified* → *pending review*.
Mandatory criteria for verified status	Verified status requires a government ID matching the profile name and confirming age 18 or over, a confirmed phone number, at least one contactable reference, and no unresolved report against the account.
Administrator decision	The administrator can approve or reject with a reason; the outcome is written to the record and the user is notified. Status becomes *verified* or *rejected*.
Visible badge	A verified badge appears on the profile and on every booking card. An unverified parent cannot confirm a booking; an unverified staff member does not appear in search results.
Re-submission after rejection	A rejected user can correct and resubmit; the history of prior submissions is retained for audit.

F4 · Live photo plausibility check M

An optional step within F3. The user captures a live selfie in the browser; the system asks a vision-capable language model whether the selfie plausibly depicts the person on the submitted ID, and shows the answer to the administrator alongside both images.

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
In-browser capture	The camera preview, capture and retake all work on desktop and mobile; a user who declines camera permission can continue and still reach verified status.
Plausibility result	The model returns one of *likely match*, *uncertain*, *likely mismatch*, with a short written explanation. Malformed responses are recorded as *unavailable*, never guessed.
Advisory only	The result cannot itself change verification status. The administrator's decision is the only thing that does, and the interface states this on screen.
Consent	Before any capture the user is told the photo is sent to a third-party AI service for a non-certified plausibility check, and is offered the option to skip.

F5 · Search, filtering and weighted matching M

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Structured filters	A parent can filter by area, date and time, hourly-rate ceiling, minimum experience and skill tags; results update on apply and the active filter set is visible.
Weighted score	Every result carries a score from area fit, rating, experience, budget fit and availability fit, with documented weights. Results are ordered by score, not by listing date.
Visible breakdown	Each result card can be expanded to show each component's contribution in plain language, e.g. *same area +30, rating 4.8 +24, within budget +20*.
Exclusions	Unverified, incomplete and inactive staff never appear. A staff member unavailable for the requested slot is either excluded or clearly marked, never silently ranked.
Empty state	When nothing matches, the interface names the most restrictive filter and offers to relax it.

F6 · AI natural-language search S

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Plain-language parsing	A request such as *someone in Tema for two afternoons a week, good with toddlers, under 25 cedis an hour* produces the equivalent structured filters.
Filters shown before use	The extracted filters are displayed as editable chips before results are returned, so the parent can correct a misreading.
Graceful failure	If parsing fails or returns malformed output, the parent is returned to the manual filters with their text preserved. Search is never blocked by the model.

F7 · Ward Care Profile M

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
One profile per child	A parent can create, edit and archive a profile per child holding name or initials, age, medications, meal times, homework and play schedule, special needs and general notes.
Automatic attachment	Every booking request carries the selected child's profile; the staff member sees it with the request, before deciding, without the parent re-entering anything.
Edits propagate	An edit is reflected on all future and active bookings. Completed bookings retain the version in force at completion.
Data minimisation	Only information necessary for care is collected; the form states this and marks every field beyond age and care instructions as optional.

F8 · Booking lifecycle M

The booking is the platform's central record. Its status sequence is *pending* → *accepted* → *paid* → *active* → *completed*, with *declined* and *cancelled* as terminal branches.

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Request	A verified parent selects a staff member, sets date and time window, chooses a child, adds one-off notes and confirms an emergency contact. The request is created as *pending*.
Accept or decline	The staff member sees the request with the parent's verification badge and Ward Care Profile and responds. On acceptance the rate, date, time and duration lock and cannot be edited by either party.
Session start and end	Either party can mark the session *active* on the day, and *completed* afterwards; each transition is timestamped and attributed.
Symmetric emergency-contact reveal	Emergency contacts are exchanged only while status is *active*, and to both parties simultaneously. Before and after, they are hidden.
Cancellation	Either party can cancel before the session starts, with a reason recorded; the booking becomes *cancelled* and any payment is flagged for administrator attention.
Audit trail	Every status change is retained with who made it and when, and is visible to the administrator.

F9 · Mobile Money payment M

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Network selection and initiation	The parent selects MTN, Telecel or AirtelTigo, enters the paying number, and initiates payment for the locked booking amount.
Reference attached to the booking	A payment reference and status are stored against the booking and are visible to parent, staff and administrator.
Simulated states	The simulated flow can produce success, pending and failure; a failure leaves the booking *accepted* and payable again, never in an ambiguous state.
Amount integrity	The amount is derived from the locked terms, never from client input; a mismatch is rejected server-side.

F10 · Messaging, reviews and reports S

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Booking-scoped messaging	Parent and staff can exchange messages only within a booking they both belong to; no platform-wide inbox and no contact before a request exists.
Review after completion	Only the parent on a *completed* booking can review it, once, with a 1–5 rating and optional comment. The staff member's public average recalculates immediately.
Reporting	Either party can file a report against a booking at any point. It is routed to the administrator queue, never resolved between the parties, and blocks verified status while unresolved.

F11 · Administrator dashboard and reporting M

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Roster management	The administrator can add, edit and deactivate staff records and see each one's verification and profile-completeness state at a glance.
Verification queue	Pending submissions from both roles are listed oldest first, with ID details, reference, both photos and the AI note on one screen, and approve/reject actions with a reason.
Report queue	Open reports are listed with the related booking and both parties, and can be marked investigating or resolved with a resolution note.
Operational reporting	The dashboard reports, for a selected period: bookings by status, completion and decline rates, revenue processed through the platform, average booking value, active staff count, and verification throughput.

F12 · Accessibility for low-literacy users M

REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
Voice input	Any free-text field on a staff-facing screen can be dictated; the transcript is shown for confirmation before it is saved.
Read-aloud	Any screen region on a staff-facing screen can be read aloud on demand, including field labels, helper text and booking details.
Iconography and language	Every action carries an icon as well as a label; staff-facing copy stays within short, plain sentences.
Keyboard and contrast	All interactive elements are keyboard reachable with a visible focus ring, and body text meets a 4.5:1 contrast ratio.

7. Non-functional requirements

CATEGORY	REQUIREMENT
Performance	Search results return within two seconds on a mid-range Android device over 3G-class connectivity. Lighthouse performance score above 80 on the parent dashboard and search.
Availability	The deployed application is reachable during test windows; no scheduled downtime during evaluation.
Security	Passwords are never stored in plain text; all traffic over HTTPS; every data read is authorised server-side by role and ownership, never only in the interface.
Privacy	Identity documents and verification photos are stored in access-controlled storage reachable only by the owner and the administrator, via time-limited signed URLs.
Compliance	Collection, storage and processing of personal data follow Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843).
Usability	A first-time parent completes a booking request without assistance; a staff member completes verification with voice and read-aloud only.
Responsiveness	Every screen is usable from 360px to 1440px width; no horizontal scrolling on mobile.
Maintainability	One typed codebase, documented matching weights, and commented source published to GitHub.
Auditability	Verification decisions, booking status changes and payment references are all retained with actor and timestamp.

8. Assumptions, constraints and dependencies

TYPE	STATEMENT
Assumption	Users have a smartphone or computer with internet connectivity, and a working camera where live photo verification is used.
Assumption	Parents and staff will provide accurate information and complete verification; users protect their own credentials.
Assumption	Electricity and internet are available and reliable enough for testing.
Constraint — time	The August–September 2026 window limits scope to the features listed here; nurse caregiving and multi-agency support are deferred.
Constraint — data	The system runs on simulated and mock data, including simulated Mobile Money transactions and mock document verification.
Constraint — AI	Natural-language parsing and the photo plausibility check depend on a third-party model API; accuracy is evaluated, not assumed.
Constraint — deployment	Testing is confined to a controlled environment with recruited users, not a public launch.
Dependency	Supabase (database, authentication, storage), a hosted language-model API, Vercel hosting, and browser camera and speech APIs.

9. Risks

RISK	SEVERITY	MITIGATION
AI photo check misleads the administrator	High	Result is advisory, labelled non-certified, and shown beside both source images; the administrator decides. Usefulness is measured against a manual-only baseline.
Staff abandon self-service verification	High	Voice input and read-aloud throughout; the administrator can submit on a staff member's behalf from the roster.
Compressed timeline	High	Phased build with a functional core first; F6 and parts of F10 are the designated cut candidates.
Model API latency or outage	Medium	Both AI features degrade to manual paths; neither blocks a core flow.
Sensitive photo data sent to a third party	Medium	Explicit pre-capture disclosure, skippable step, data minimisation, and a documented production path to a compliant provider.
Simulated payments mistaken for real settlement	Medium	Simulation is labelled in the interface and in all documentation and test scripts.
Low participant recruitment for evaluation	Medium	Recruit through the partner agency's existing client and staff base, with a 10-participant floor.

10. Release plan

RELEASE	WINDOW	CONTENTS
R1 Foundation	Week 1	Environment, database, authentication, role-based access, shell layouts (F1).
R2 Core	Week 2	Staff profiles and directory, Ward Care Profile, weighted matching, booking request and accept/decline (F2, F5, F7, F8).
R3 Enhancement	Weeks 3–4	Bidirectional verification with live photo check, administrator roster and queues, Mobile Money flow, natural-language search, voice and read-aloud, reviews, messaging, reports (F3, F4, F6, F9, F10, F11, F12).
R4 Finalisation	Week 5	Testing and defect fixing, AI feature evaluation, documentation, deployment, user testing.

11. Open questions

1. Does the agency take a commission per booking, and should the platform compute and report it separately from gross revenue?
2. Are staff paid out through the platform, or does the agency settle with staff outside it? This determines whether a payout record is needed.
3. Should a parent be able to book the same staff member on a recurring weekly schedule, or is each session a separate booking for this build?
4. Who acts as administrator in practice — the owner alone, or several agency staff sharing one role?
5. How long should verification photographs be retained after a decision is recorded?